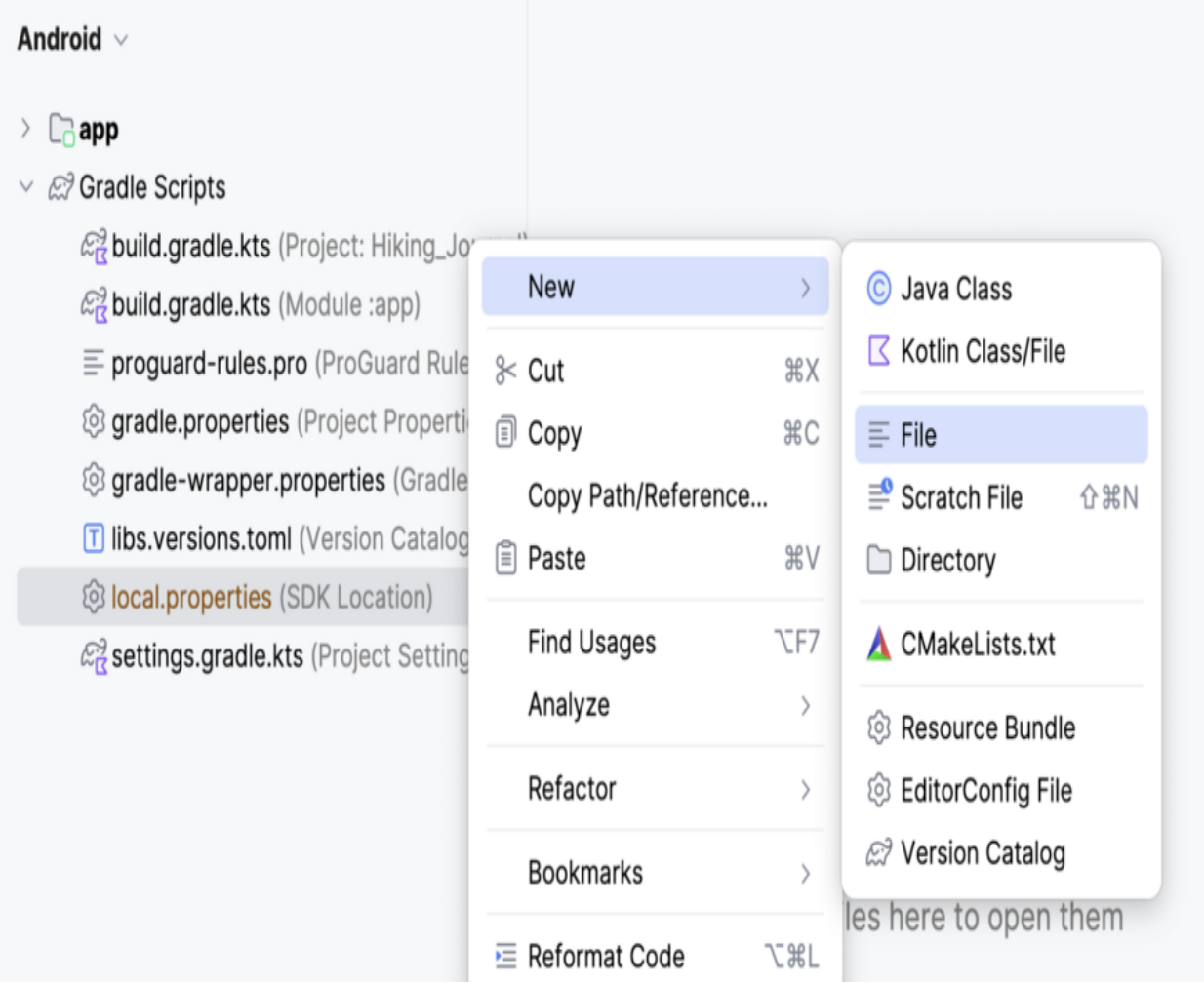


Add your API key to this file like so:

```
MAPS_API_KEY=AIzaXXXXXX-XXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXXX
```

To keep the key secure, we won't check the secrets file into version control. Tell git to ignore it by appending `secrets.properties` to the bottom of `.gitignore`. Do this by running the following command from the `android` directory on the command line: `echo secrets.properties >> .gitignore`.

To reference the key, we'll use the Secrets Gradle plugin,[35] as recommended by Google. Add the plugin to the top of your app's `build.gradle.kts` and tell it where to find the secrets file.

ch06_15/android/app/build.gradle.kts